

Speaker 1 [00:00:02] Okay. First of all, do you agree to participate in the study in accordance with the informed consent form I sent you yesterday?

Speaker 2: I do.

Speaker 1: Okay. First of all, we will start with a few demographic questions. How old are you?

Speaker 2: I am [20-22] years old.

Speaker 1: [20-25]. How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:49] We've been together for [<1 year].

Speaker 1 [00:00:51] Okay. Do you have any children?

Speaker 2: No.

Speaker 1: No. Who do you live with at home?

Speaker 2 [00:01:05] Me and my cat.

Speaker 1 [00:01:14] I think there's a connection problem, could you repeat that?

Speaker 2: I'm alive.

Speaker 1: I didn't get it again, can you repeat it?

Speaker 2: Can you hear me now?

Speaker 1: It's intermittent.

Speaker 2 [00:01:33] There is a bit of a problem with the internet for some reason I can't help myself. Can you hear me clearly right now?

Speaker 1 [00:01:38] I'm getting it better now.

Speaker 2 [00:01:40] Okay. Me and my cat live in the house.

Speaker 1 [00:01:44] Okay. What is your main source of income?

Speaker 2 [00:01:49] I get support from my family and I work at the same time.

Speaker 1 [00:02:33] Okay. So can I ask about your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:02:41] I am a [occupation] at [Company Name].

Speaker 1 [00:02:46] Okay. So what would you like us to call your partner? Boyfriend, lover, partner.

Speaker 2: Lover.

Speaker 1: Lover. Speaker 1 [00:02:00] Okay. So, how would you like me to meet...

Speaker 1 [00:00:02] Lastly, I think, to your partner, lover.

Speaker 2 [00:00:04] Do I have a video?.

Speaker 1 [00:00:07] I have that right now.

Speaker 2: Okay.

Speaker 1: Last time I think you agreed that we should refer to your partner as your lover. That's all right. Now I'm going to ask questions in a more romantic context. Can you tell me the story of how you met and how your relationship started?

Speaker 2 [00:00:35] He came across me. After I followed him. I wanted to wait for a while because I was in love with him at first, I was a little shy. After a few days, we actually started our conversation by commenting on a photo He posted. Afterwards, I realized that I was getting more and more interested every day and wanted to get to know him a little more. That's when it all started on [Month Day]. By doing things together, spending time together and constantly getting to know each other or trying to understand each other and trying to establish something, we realized that it was actually complementary.

Speaker 1 [00:02:12] I can only hear you intermittently right now.

Speaker 2 [00:02:13] And then we've already become lovers. I'll hold for a second.

Speaker 1 [00:02:32] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:02:33] How do I sound right now?

Speaker 1 [00:02:35] I think it's better now.

Speaker 2 [00:02:38] Okay. I'm adjusting it now. Shall I explain it again or can you understand my voice?

Speaker 1 [00:02:45] Not quite clear. I would appreciate it if you could start again.

Speaker 2 [00:02:49] Okay. We met him through social media. He was not in [Country] at that time. Then we followed him on [Social Media] and a few days later.

Speaker 1 [00:03:16] I can't hear you right now.

Speaker 2 [00:03:16] A conversation started from there. We realized that we had a very compatible life energy and I was already very much attracted to him.

Speaker 2: Is it coming now? It is coming now. I stayed at the last part where you followed me. I commented on him photo on [Social Media]. Our whole conversation started from there. Then, as the days went by, we realized that some things matched and that we complemented each other. And I had a very strong desire: to see him, to talk to him, to spend time with him. And then we came face to face, and after we came face to face, there was a feeling not as if we wanted to get to know each other, but as if we had known each other for years and had a relationship for years. In this way, my feelings started to intensify even more. After a certain period of time, when our friend suddenly asked us a question like “so are you lovers or flirts?”. I was not such a person at the time, but for a moment I said we were like lovers, so we became lovers. Actually, it was a funny story. The good part of the job is that we started to get to know each other in the relationship. We started to understand each other and learn about each other. So and so, we passed [<1 year].

Speaker 1 [00:05:01] Well, okay. Moving on to the next question, how would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:05:10] I mean, if I were to rate it on a scale of one to 10, honestly, my friends' relationships are usually around 6 or 7. But in my relationship with my girlfriend, I can clearly give myself an 8 or 9 because there is a mutual understanding. Even if we don't verbalize certain things sometimes, we can understand each other from our looks or any reaction. Therefore, I am in a much, much better quality relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:05:41] I understand that you think this understanding and non-verbal communication part is more lacking in the relationships of our other friends.

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: Hmm. So what other elements of your relationship would you say make your relationship of higher quality compared to the relationships of your other friends?

Speaker 2 [00:06:07] Can I take the question again, you've been cut off.

Speaker 1 [00:06:12] Of course. You talked about nonverbal communication and understanding. What can you say about the other elements that make your own work of a higher quality compared to the relationships of your peers around you?

Speaker 2 [00:06:27] Like this. Apart from nonverbal communication, we are also able to express certain things openly to each other, knowing that it will not hurt each other. Apart from that, frankly, I think this is a way of thinking that comes from the past, no matter who the person we are with, both in my relationship dynamics and in his relationship dynamics, he has the ability to communicate like friends and friends before. I mean, I don't just look at my lover as a person I spend time with by using nice words, but also as a confidant, a friend, a buddy, a brother, a parent figure. And I think that's one of the most valuable things.

Speaker 1 [00:07:14] Well, for example, can you give concrete examples of seeing them as friends?

Speaker 2 [00:07:20] I mean like this. Obviously, there are some activities that lovers do in general and that are very stereotyped or very long-standing. What are these for example? Going to the movies, having dinner together, going out for dinner, ideas like buying roses, for example. We don't include ourselves too much in these taboos. When the time comes, we can joke with each other about the details that are funny to each other and express them in a way that does not offend each other. Or I can sit and talk to him/her about the things I go through on a daily basis, I can talk to him/her like a big brother, and he/she can not only listen to me, but also make inferences and give me advice from his/her own point of view, with his/her own feelings. So it's a mutual thing.

Speaker 1 [00:08:12] Okay, thank you very much. Can I ask you how many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:08:20] Apart from this relationship, I have had two other relationships in the past.

Speaker 1 [00:08:24] Hmm. So how would you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:08:31] I mean, I can't be too modest about it, my previous relationship was between one and ten, I can't give a number above four, whereas now

Speaker 1 [00:08:55] You were silent after 4.

Speaker 2 [00:08:59] Before that I could really give my relationship a quality of 4 between one and ten, very much because there was no communication. The other side was only continuing the relationship by imposing their own truths. But in my current relationship, I can honestly give 9 or 10 between 1 and 10. In that 9, maybe there are certain roughnesses, there are points where we cannot understand each other or because of different perspectives. But other than that, I am really in an incredibly high quality relationship right now.

Speaker 1 [00:09:35] Well, apart from this open communication, what other factors do you think make your relationship better quality compared to your previous relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:09:44] I mean, at the beginning of everything, I think that the basis of the relationship should be respect before love, because we all come from different cultures and different locations. The location I am talking about is purely physical geographical location. And compared to my previous relationship, I have never had any problems with my past life or where I grew up in my current relationship. Because the other party approached me with the awareness of this. Or he accepted me knowing that I have different habits. So the basis is this: We started a relationship by accepting me as I am because I am me. I also progressed in this way.

Speaker 1 [00:10:35] Okay. So what are the elements that make a relationship high quality for you?

Speaker 2 [00:10:43] First of all, as I said, respect for the other party. This is the most basic thing. Because when you lose respect, you cannot find a detail to love. Apart from that, loyalty is one of the most basic things. Because if I have to be a little clear. We live in a metropolis like [City A] and there are gay individuals living here with very open identities. I have endless respect for them. But because they have different perspectives and different lifestyles, there can be incidents that can be taken to very different places. At this point, I think that I should feel loyalty to my partner, my lover or the person I share this life with, whatever we call it, at the beginning of everything. Because I think that when something is seen for nothing, this person really needs to respect and honor it. Apart from that. Understanding maybe. In other words, understanding each other, at least being able to console each other, trying to understand things without necessarily communicating verbally or showing things in an overt, concrete way. In this way.

Speaker 1 [00:11:59] So then you think you can understand that a person is in a high quality relationship with respect, loyalty and understanding?

Speaker 2 [00:12:10] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:12:11] So when we think about your own relationship, when would you say your relationship is respectful or at least when would you consider it to be respectful?

Speaker 2 [00:12:24] I mean, the times that I think are the most respectful are the following: Of course, [6-10] months is an easy period of time, but when we talk about our childhood, our younger teenagers or our family life, when we talk about the things we have experienced at the point where we talk about our childhood, our younger teenagers or our family life, when the following answers come from the other side, frankly, I feel very respected. You know, no matter what happens, no matter what I go through, no matter what I go through, the fact that he finds a point that I take out of everything I go through and shows them to me and that I stand up despite these things or that I am not complacent, and at the end of everything, the sentence "I am proud of you no matter what happens" is something that really keeps me very much alive, and I try to do this to the other side as much as I can. Like this.

Speaker 1 [00:13:20] So if we ask the same for loyalty, when do you think your relationship is most loyal or least loyal?

Speaker 2 [00:13:30] Well, the points where I think there is the least fidelity are usually in places where there are a lot of homosexual individuals, and when we are in these environments when we are not side by side with each other, inevitably there can be a paranoia. Because there are a lot of things we hear from the environment, there are very bad lives, bad incidents, and in such situations, I can't help but speak for myself, I get a little nervous and with an instinct of self-protection, sometimes I put myself in such a constriction. But let me also say that I have overcome this a little bit now. The point that I think is the most loyal is this. He is in France right now and I trust him with my eyes closed. I believe in what he should do and I know that he will do it. He makes me feel this very much and there is absolutely no question mark in my mind anymore, I think this is his success: Is he okay? Will something happen to him? Or will someone do something, will he slip up? I don't have any of these question marks right now.

Speaker 1 [00:14:39] Okay, finally.. And finally, I want to ask you the same thing about the receptive part, when would you say your relationship is receptive and when would you say it's not receptive?

Speaker 2 [00:15:01] I mean I have almost no examples where I would say that it's not understanding. Because really darling I really want to say it in a really big way at this point. My life is not very easy right now, to be honest. I live far away from my family, as we all have difficulties in our lives. At the same time, I have a working order, I have an education order, and in the process of trying to keep this life afloat, inevitably, because there are constantly obstacles in front of me,

structurally, sometimes my tension can react too much, and at every point, no matter what, the fact that he listens to me with incredible patience and calms me down makes him very top points in terms of understanding.

Speaker 1 [00:15:49] Thank you very much. You actually touched on some of these in your previous answers but I want to ask you again because it is one of our main research topics: What are the most important things in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2 [00:16:05] Respect, loyalty, understanding are the most basic things that should be the most basic in a relationship, but apart from these, the things that really make a relationship beautiful are unbelievable, such unexpected or unthought-of things that suddenly come up. If I give an example of this, let me give a small example. Let's say he is coming from somewhere or he came out of school and suddenly he saw me at the door. To make him feel that happiness at that moment is much more valuable than the most expensive, the most beautiful, the gift that will make him happy. Or I work, for example, coming to my work exit, coming to my break, small gestures. Or the smallest gesture, a word can really make people incredibly happy and I think it has a lot of impact on the person in a good way and also raises the other party's place in the person very much.

Speaker 1 [00:17:09] Okay. So what is love according to you?

Speaker 2 [00:17:13] To me, love is this: If I were to say this from my past experiences, I honestly can't answer too much, but if I were to tell you about love in my current relationship: If I really look into your eyes every time I look into your eyes, I shiver to the bone like the first time I saw it, and when the other person looks at me, I can see myself in their eyes and feel their love, even if they don't touch me. I think that's really love.

Speaker 1 [00:17:46] Okay. So how important do you think love is in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:17:52] Love in a relationship is like this: If the building blocks I mentioned are not present, they are not important in any way because they already constitute love. I think love is not a phrase that must be found, but I interpret it as a whole formed by certain things. It is like that.

Speaker 1 [00:18:18] Okay. So how do you know if your lover loves you?



Speaker 2 [00:18:28] It's like this: There are certain details that I sometimes talk about. Details about my past life or details that are important to me. When it comes up or when it's time to talk about it, the way I first told it or the way I answer a question, the way it comes back to me. Or how can I say it? The fact that it calms the trembling of my body when he really hugs me or that I feel this trembling in him, frankly, causes a lot of these. Apart from that, I have many concrete examples. For example, there is a certain distance, we both live in [City A]. There is a considerable distance between us. He gets up and comes to me when he can't reach me, he is curious about me, he tells me some things with such a parental figure. Giving me advice. These actually make me feel.

Speaker 1 [00:19:28] Hmm I see. So what would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:19:36] I mean, first of all, the biggest challenge in our relationship is the environmental factors. These are generally due to the general mentality of the country. Apart from that, again it's a related issue, but at the end of the day, we are all children of a family and some families may not accept certain things or may not be understanding. Honestly, this is one of our biggest obstacles. Apart from that, one day tomorrow, when we are really sure about something and we are fully committed to each other and we want to take our relationship to the next level, there is a huge constitutional barrier in front of us. We cannot get married. These and similar reasons actually. I honestly don't see any other reasons.

Speaker 1 [00:20:27] So do you and your lover fight?

Speaker 2 [00:20:32] Rather than fighting, there are some points where we argue and disagree. These are not very big things anyway.

Speaker 1 [00:20:41] So how often do these arguments happen?

Speaker 2 [00:20:45] I mean, honestly, there is no frequency I can give. I mean, sometimes there is no problem for a month in our relationship. Sometimes, but we have some discussions every two days on a regular basis. But as a result of these, we can think about this: The reason why we are having this argument again is that we could not solve that issue completely or we could not really understand each other, we could not listen to each other.

Speaker 1 [00:21:10] So what are these discussions usually about?

Speaker 2 [00:21:14] These arguments are usually about my jealousy. I'm a bit overprotective, and there's only one reason for that: I had some bad experiences in my past relationship, bad experiences. This is not only in my relationship, but also in some of my friends around me. And in line with this, I will say it again, but with the protective instinct, people can react differently or overreact to some things. That's why usually.

Speaker 1 [00:21:47] So how do you solve these arguments?

Speaker 2 [00:21:52] Well, the other person doesn't just come to me with some, with this jealousy, they don't just come to me with concrete things or they don't just come to me with abstract things. Obviously, when he gives me an explanation, when he speaks in a language that I understand or when he makes me feel and show me something in an overt way, that's when the issue is completely resolved or when he calms me down.

Speaker 1 [00:22:21] Well, for example, about speaking in your own language. Can you elaborate a little bit more here?

Speaker 2 [00:22:27] Like this. My girlfriend doesn't like or I shouldn't say He doesn't like to prolong things too much or explain things in such detail, He doesn't prefer it too much. In general, he uses short and concise clear words, he uses concise sentences. But sometimes when I sometimes get dizzy, what I mean by dizzy is that at the point that I cannot understand, he explains those sentences in detail, one by one, down to the finest detail. If I want to use slang, he tells it like he is explaining it to those who don't understand, and at that point, when I calm down, we get along.

Speaker 1 [00:23:10] Okay. Apart from the fact that he speaks your language, thinking about you, what are the other ways to maintain the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:23:25] I would say making time. This is a very important thing. More precisely, creating time rather than making time. I mean, for example, I can somehow find an excuse and postpone the meeting with him/her by making an excuse that I'm off work or I'm tired or I'm sleep deprived. And when I do that, I can definitely get respect and positive reactions from the other side. Or he can tell me when he gets out of school, when he has something to do, and so on, and he can experience the same situation. But the thing is that we can really create such good times for each other. I mean, I realize I'm going on with too many examples.

Speaker 1 [00:24:08] Please.

Speaker 2 [00:24:10] Even though I left work at 10:30 and I had worked 12 hours that day, I was on my feet for 12 hours, he just said to me, "I really love you...". He said the word, the sentence. We hung up the phone and I went from [Location A to Location B] just to see him for half an hour, let me put it that way.

Speaker 1 [00:24:28] Okay. So would you say that this relationship was good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:24:35] Definitely.

Speaker 1 [00:24:36] So why do you think that?

Speaker 2 [00:24:41] It's like this. It's actually about the cornerstones. I feel understood, because as I said, after some traumas, when people see the opposite of the person who caused them, they see that they are actually very normal and possible. Until this time, I was a very incomprehensible person in my past relationships, but it is very valuable that the other person understands me, my past, the process I went through or the emotional changes I went through, is understanding and can speak the same language with me in line with these. Other than that, I honestly don't think of much else.

Speaker 1 [00:25:26] Okay. So has this relationship changed you?

Speaker 2: Absolutely.

Speaker 1: how has it changed?

Speaker 2 [00:25:36] So, first of all, I have contributed a lot to the other side and the other side has contributed a lot to me. It's not just understanding each other or material things or spiritual things. It is in every aspect. It can be academic, it can be an opinion, it can be a point of view. We add something to each other in every subject, maybe every day. Apart from that, I mean, it can really make you feel something and it does it successfully. I think I have realized it too. like this.

Speaker 1 [00:26:17] Well, for example, you said that it adds something to you academically or in daily life. Can you give concrete examples here?

Speaker 2 [00:26:26] I mean, if I can talk about it from an emotional point of view: I mean, as I just said, I am actually a very tense person, but since the day I started my relationship with him, I started to calm down more and more every day and I started to react to things more voluntarily, more calmly, more logically. Apart from that, there is a language he knows. He knows French. I know German. We can help each other with language development for example. Or when he has a point about schools, when he needs an idea, when he needs inspiration for a project, I think I can support him. At a point where I cannot solve a problem related to my work, it does not necessarily have to be a work on paper. When I have a problem with a friend, he actually proves this by showing me different perspectives. Apart from that, there is also the financial dimension. I am currently living in my own house. Yes, I get support from my family, but as a result, there are situations where I have some problems, where I cannot get out of the business financially, and at this point, it can catch up with me instantly.

Speaker 1 [00:27:39] Okay. And did your partner change during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:27:45] During the relationship, it's like this: the change in both of us is actually more of a healing and a return to the essence rather than a change. I think that there is a person inside of us and the things that we go through either damage that person or silence that person. But since the day we started the relationship, I think it's really about understanding each other and bringing out the real person inside of each other.

Speaker 1 [00:28:14] So for example, if you were to give concrete examples of healing in your partner, what would you give?

Speaker 2 [00:28:21] Like this: When we first started our relationship, within a month and a half, he told me that the person in his past relationship punished him with not being with him, that he punished him in that way by seeing him very rarely. When I was having a discussion about this later on, when I was talking to him in a normal way, He told me that He was afraid of this and that He had a fear of what I would do to him, what I would do to him. For example, I don't think He has such a fear anymore because I think that I made him feel that such a thing would not be possible with the things I made him feel, the things I did or the way I behaved, and I think that I made him feel that no matter what happens, we can sit down and talk to each other and we can sit down with each other at the points where we are angry or upset with each other and solve it, and I think that He has made a good progress in this regard.

Speaker 1 [00:29:21] Okay. So do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:29:25] Absolutely.

Speaker 1 [00:29:26] Can you explain a little bit more why you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:29:30] It's like this. Whatever happens in the process of finding the house that I'm living in now, or during certain tensions with my family, and if I was really in my life before my boyfriend, I could turn around and say I'm so sorry (no context!).

Speaker 1 [00:29:50] what do you mean. I didn't get the full question, I think there was no sound.

Speaker 2 [00:30:34] Do you hear me now?

Speaker 1 [00:30:36] I'm getting it now.

Speaker 2 [00:30:38] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:30:38] Can I get the question again?

Speaker 1 [00:30:39] Of course. You said that you feel safe in this relationship. Why do you feel that way?

Speaker 2 [00:30:47] Well. In my process of finding this house, in the tensions I experienced in my family, etc., the fact that he somehow took an attitude with me as if he was actually fighting this struggle, reacted in that way, and at that point when I was tired, he did not let me fall and picked me up. And apart from that, when you go out, there is a perception that any gay individual cannot hold hands or kiss the person they are in a relationship with. And these people are afraid of any negative reaction or reaction from the outside. But when he is with me, I hold his hand and I kiss him. And at the point where someone says something, I can either ignore it or at the point where they do something, I can feel the power to defend them and myself.

Speaker 1 [00:31:43] okay. I will share a screen with you now.

Speaker 2 [00:31:48] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:31:53] Can you see it?

Speaker 2 [00:31:55] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:31:56] If I asked you, “my partner usually really listens to me,” what would you give on a scale of one to nine?

Speaker 2 [00:32:08] I would give it an eight.

Speaker 1 [00:32:10] Eight, okay. So, if I asked, “My partner is usually sensitive to my needs,” again, what would you give on this scale of one to nine?

Speaker 2: Nine.

Speaker 1: nine, okay. On our first item, “my partner usually really listens to me”, why did you give an 8?

Speaker 2 [00:32:38] It's like this. In general, he can sit and listen to what I'm telling him and really clear his head in that moment and focus completely on me. But when there are some points, maybe the topic is something that he doesn't understand or something that he has never heard before, he gets very distracted or he doesn't fully understand what I am trying to say. We experience such situations very rarely. Of course, I think it is very natural.

Speaker 1 [00:33:08] Okay. And when does this usually happen? Can you give concrete examples?

Speaker 2 [00:33:14] I mean like this. The most concrete and the most logical example I can give is this. We all come from different families and the way our family behaves towards us, the way they look at us or the way we look at our family, the way they behave is very different. He has a different family dynamic and structure. I have a different family dynamic and structure, and when they are talking about these things, I can see the points that he doesn't understand. Or I can feel that even if he listens to me fully, he doesn't understand something, which is also very natural. Because he doesn't have my background. I don't have his background or his current point of view, mentality. So I think that's why.

Speaker 1 [00:33:55] And why eight and not seven or nine?

Speaker 2 [00:34:02] I mean, I actually said 8 because there are very few examples like that. Apart from that, if he had experienced literally everything I have experienced, and there are things he has experienced, but if I could reflect, explain or he had experienced something about it, it would definitely be 9.

Speaker 1 [00:34:24] Uh-huh, okay. Why did you answer 9 for our second item “my partner is usually sensitive to my needs”?

Speaker 2 [00:34:35] I gave him a nine, and here's why. I mean, he is a person who is a little bit higher than me financially at some point. This is an undeniable fact. I already see that. But at the point where I say something and when there is an event or something that I make a logical explanation for, he can support me without question in exactly what he needs to be. I mean, most recently we had this. I live with my cat. And my cat has a small health problem. We look at him, for example, not as my own cat, but as our two cats, our two cats, or even our daughter, as we call him. And when He had a health problem, for example, I called him and told him that there was such a situation. There are examples such as He directly covered that expense without question.

Speaker 1 [00:35:28] Okay, so why nine and not eight?

Speaker 2 [00:35:33] I mean, in my [<1 year] relationship, because not once did he react directly to something like this or something close to this without questioning. He never said “I wonder” or “but”. That's why.

Speaker 1 [00:35:49] Okay. I hope you don't mind asking and if this is a very sensitive subject for you to share please feel free to say so. But we also wanted to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker 2 [00:36:08] Well, recently, I mean, in the last week, we can't because he is out of the city and out of the country. But other than that, we can see him three or four times a week. Either he comes to my house or I go to his house during the time he is available, which is not for a purpose, but rather everything develops instantaneously. Sometimes it can change, these three or four, maybe it can go up to 6 or 7 in a week.

Speaker 1 [00:36:36] So how satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:36:41] I am absolutely satisfied with it.

Speaker 1 [00:36:43] So can you explain a little bit more why you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:36:47] Let me put it this way. Maybe it's a little bit related to emotionality, because when you touch him, it's like the first hug when he hugs you, it's like the first time I look into his eyes. And really, when he touches me, something inside me starts to tremble, something starts to move like this. I feel good, I feel safe, and I can feel that he and I trust each other in that sexuality: I think the most vulnerable moment for people is when they look at each other naked. It's the moment when they're facing each other and we can be intimate without any hesitation whatsoever. So definitely because of that.

Speaker 1 [00:37:33] So how important do you think sexuality is or is it important in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:37:39] Definitely important. On a scale of 1 to 10, I would say 8. And the reason for this is this: In fact, in terms of non-verbal communication, it is not necessarily a look or a gesture or a gesture, but there is also sexuality. Because I think sexuality is also something that heals couples, makes them feel good and keeps them more vigorous. This is not only in terms of emotion, but also in terms of health. It's also physically.

Speaker 1 [00:38:13] Okay. Now I'm going to share a screen with you again. If I ask you how satisfied you are with your relationship in general, which one of these options would you choose?

Speaker 2: Completely satisfied

Speaker 1: completely satisfied. So how would you rate your satisfaction in your relationship on this scale from not at all satisfied to completely satisfied?

Speaker 2 [00:38:46] I would say completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:38:48] That's 10, okay. Can I ask you why you gave 10 to this question?



Speaker 2 [00:38:58] The last one, I think.

Speaker 1 [00:38:59] Uh-huh. To the question of your satisfaction in your relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:39:01] I mean, it's something that starts from the foundation. Finding the missing parts in each other, always listening to each other with understanding and trying to understand each other, even if we don't fully understand, we really see that effort from the other person. Obviously, my satisfaction with this relationship already reflects my satisfaction as ten, but apart from that, the way we communicate as if we have our own language between us or the way we evaluate our beautiful moments. These are the things that please me very, very much.

Speaker 1 [00:39:38] Hmm so what exactly do you mean by finding the missing pieces for example?

Speaker 2 [00:39:46] I mean, for example, my missing piece was actually understanding. It was the other person understanding me or at least trying to understand me. He made up for this lack in me. He also at some points. Maybe the missing part or the building blocks that would make him feel that he was really in a relationship were given to him, made him live. This is not necessarily a material thing, it can be purely emotional. That's why I actually said something like that.

Speaker 1 [00:40:21] Well, you also talked about making the most of the good moments. Could you elaborate a little bit on evaluating these beautiful moments? For example, how do you evaluate, or how to evaluate a more beautiful moment in a high relationship quality relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:40:35] I mean, both of us are basically people who love luxury. But we don't have a perception that we should go to very luxurious places, eat very luxurious food, hang out very luxuriously in our relationship, for example on our month anniversaries. I think this is what makes the relationship the best quality. Sometimes we eat in a very expensive restaurant. Sometimes we can eat in a very cheap place, in a street food place and laugh looking at each other. Or we can sit outside with friends and have a cocktail. In an extremely luxurious way or in a luxurious place. But sometimes we can go and have a cup of tea in a very average place and chat and make each other happy and laugh.

Speaker 1 [00:41:27] Okay. We are about to finish now. I would like to summarize what we talked about in the last hour. Of course, if there is something you want to add or something you think is not right, we can change it. First of all, we started with demographic questions. You said that you are [20-25] years old, you have been in a relationship for [<1 year] and your main source of income is your family and your job as a [occupation]. You said that you met your partner [<1 year] ago

through social media. You started by commenting on his or her photo. Then on [Month Day] your relationship started and you said that you actually enjoyed spending time with each other so much that you felt as if you had known him or her for years. I then asked you about the elements in a relationship that make a relationship of high quality, and you talked about the importance of understanding, of nonverbal communication and open communication, and the importance of having a friendship beforehand rather than actually being lovers. When you compared your past relationships, you said that in your previous relationships there was less communication and respect, whereas in this relationship respect and communication make this relationship higher quality. You said that what makes a relationship of high quality is respect, loyalty, understanding and respect for the past. When I asked you about love for you, you said that you can look into his eyes and feel love like the first day. When I asked you how important love is in a relationship, you said that love is when the basic building blocks are in place, but that without these building blocks, love is not so important. You said that you know that your partner loves you when they remember details, when they are curious about you, when they give you advice. You emphasized that the main challenges in your relationship are environmental factors and the mentality of the country, and that your main topics of discussion are usually jealousy, which you solve by talking about it, especially when he/she explains it in your language. You emphasized that one of the key elements of maintaining a relationship is to make time. You said that this relationship heals you and adds a lot to you, both academically and in daily life. For example, you gave an example of {Language 1} and [Language 2]. You knew [Language 1]. Your partner knew [Language 2] and you said that you helped each other with that. He says you feel safe in this relationship. Again, does your partner really listen to you? You answered eight to the question, and you said that the reason you didn't give nine was that there were some differences in family dynamics and naturally some parts were not understood. But you said that your partner is always sensitive to you, giving the example of your cat. You emphasized that you are satisfied with your sexual life and that sexuality is a very important thing in the quality of the relationship. Again, you said that you are very satisfied in your relationship and here you emphasized the importance of completing the missing pieces, having a common language and being able to evaluate the beautiful moments together. Is there anything else you would like to add to these questions?

Speaker 2 [00:45:03] No.

Speaker 1 [00:45:04] Okay. So now before we finish I would like to talk to you about how we will handle the data. As a research project, we want to be as transparent as ethically possible and therefore we would like to know which data sharing option is the most suitable for you. The first option is to share parts of the transcript of our interview. This means that none of these transcripts will contain information that can identify you. This means that our de-identified interview transcript can be read by other researchers. The second option, if you don't mind and if you want to be a bit bolder, is to share the entire interview transcript, stripped of sensitive and overly identifying details, i.e. anonymized. With this option, there is little chance that someone who knows you will be able to piece together the details of the interview transcript and narrow down the choices, including who they believe you are among their colleagues. But there is still a small chance. Again, we will not

share any sensitive information and all information will be shared anonymously. Which is more convenient for you?

Speaker 2: The second one.

Speaker 1: Okay. Thank you very much. Finally, thank you very much for participating in this study. As I said before, this is a study that we are doing together with other countries like Brazil, Netherlands, France, USA, Philippines. In order for this study to be successful, there is one more thing I would like to say to you, if it is suitable for you. Can you nominate two close people in your life. We will ask them to suggest other couples who might be interested in this work. We will also ask them to nominate couples that you do not know or have not interacted with. In this way we aim to reach a variety of participants. Is this suitable for you?

Speaker 2: It is suitable.

Speaker 1: Okay. Apart from that, I will send you a link to a survey in a moment. This survey takes about 10 minutes. I will ask you to fill in this questionnaire with a participant code. In one part of the questionnaire it asks for your name but we fill it in with a participant code so that the data can be anonymous. And I will contact you again via message about the nominated couples. Thank you very much again. For providing us with your knowledge, your experiences, your point of view. Your participation was really valuable for us. Thank you very much again and I wish you happiness.

Speaker 2 [00:47:39] You're welcome. Thank you very much. Take care of yourselves.

Speaker 1 [00:47:42] See you soon.